

Mahatma Gandhi Short Biography

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Mahatma Gandhi Article with Biography – Including His DOB, Family, Photos, Education, Childhood. Go through **Mahatma Gandhi Quotes on Life**, Love, Freedom, Animals, etc. Share with your Friends and Loved Ones.

Mahatma Gandhi Short Biography – Mahatma Gandhi about him in Detail

Born on 2nd October 1869 in Porbandar, at school Gandhi was very shy and a mediocre student.



Date of Birth (Age): 2 October 1869, Porbandar

Nick Name: Bapu, Gandhiji, Mahatma

Death: 30 January 1948, New Delhi

Wife Name: Kasturba Gandhi (m. 1883–1944)

Brother Name: Tulsidas

Family: Putlibai Gandhi, Karamchand Gandhi

Children: 2

Mahatma Gandhi Childhood

At the age of 13, he was married as a Hindu. He goes on to state that child marriage is not something he supports.

He was born and bred to not eat meat but a school friend who was strong and brave told Gandhi that these traits were due to eating meat and convinced him to try some.

He tried some goat's meat and continued for about a year in secret, before deciding that lying to his parents was worse than not being a meat-eater and he never ate meat again.

For a short while, Gandhi also took up smoking with his friend, stealing coppers from servant's pocket money to purchase the cigarettes.

Once he grew up though, he had no desire to smoke and saw smoking as dirty and harmful. At the age of 16, Gandhi's father died. A few days later his **wife Kasturba** gave birth, but their child only survived a few days.

After passing his final school exams, Gandhi went to England to study law. He was given his mother's permission by vowing not to touch wine, women or meat. He left from Bombay and set sail on 4th September 1888.

Once arriving at Southampton, he went straight to London, staying first at a hotel and then with an English family. He tried to become an English gentleman and assimilate into society by reading newspapers, buying a hat and learning to tie a tie.

He also briefly took dancing lessons and was taught to play the violin, but neither of these two things lasted more than a few months. What then followed was a period of intense study and modest living.

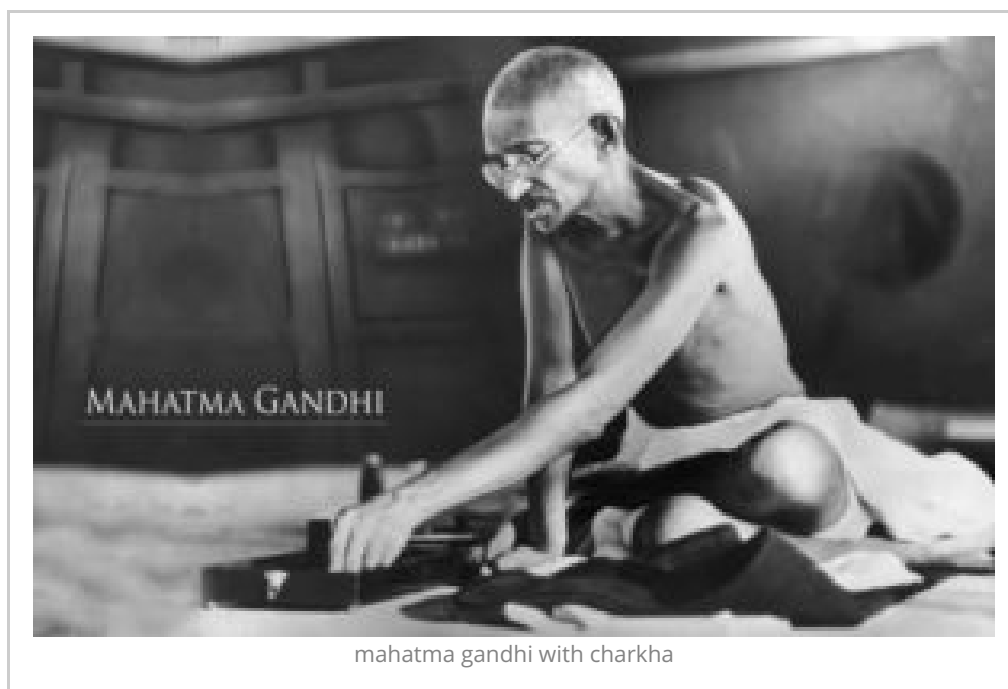
However, in his last year in England in 1890, he did travel to Paris to a great exhibition, where the prime attraction was the newly built Eiffel Tower.

After three years in England, Gandhi passed his exams and became qualified to practice law. He returned to India in the summer of 1891 to find that his mother had passed away while he was abroad. Gandhi worked in the High Court in Bombay, gaining experience and studying Indian law.

However, in one particular case, he was due to cross-examine a witness but his shyness rendered him speechless. He handed back his fee for the case and left Bombay, returning to Rajkot where his elder **brother name Tulsidas** lived and set up an office there.

In 1893, Gandhi was offered a contract from an Indian firm who were involved in a court case in South Africa. Gandhi jumped at the chance of a new experience and seeing a new country and set off in April, leaving behind his wife and their now two children.

After several stops in places such as Mombasa and Zanzibar, Gandhi arrived in Natal in May. Whilst in South Africa Gandhi suffered many prejudices such as being kicked out of first class on a train despite having a ticket and being asked to eat dinner in his room so as not to offend other hotel guests in the restaurant, all because of his color.



After traveling to Pretoria, he met some Christian friends and began to study the Christian religion but vowed not to embrace any other religion before he fully understood his own – Hinduism.

It was the year he spent in Pretoria that gave him a true knowledge in the legal practice and where he gained the confidence to be a successful lawyer. After winning the Indian company's case, Gandhi returned to Durban in Natal.

There he assisted fellow Indians in opposing a bill that denied them the right to vote. He continued his social activism by helping found the Natal Indian Congress which helped the Indian community unite as a political force.

After three years in South Africa, he returned to India for six months to pick up his wife and two sons and brought them all back to Durban. However, on arrival to the port, Gandhi discovered that many of the white residents of Durban were not happy with him and he was charged with 1.

Taking part in the unmerited condemnation of Natal whites while he was in India. 2. Trying to swamp Natal with Indians by bringing over shiploads of passengers to achieve this aim.

Both accusations were false so Gandhi went ashore. He was soon surrounded by a crowd who threw stones, bricks, and rotten eggs at him. Luckily the police soon arrived and escorted him to his friend's house. The crowds would not disperse so Gandhi eventually fled the house, disguised as a police constable.

He made a statement saying he did not want to prosecute anyone who attacked him. Gandhi proved his innocence of both charges through being interviewed by the press and they declared him innocent.

Gandhi and his wife had two more sons in South Africa after which he took a vow of celibacy. In 1900, soon after the Boer War broke out, Gandhi and a group of his friends created an Ambulance corps, carrying the wounded on stretchers within the line of fire, participating on the side of the British Empire.

Once he was relieved of war duties, Gandhi returned to India. He went on a tour of the country, traveling third class to acquaint himself with the hardships of third class passengers. The journey spanned from Calcutta to Benares, Agra, Jaipur, Palanpur, and Rajkot, spending one day in each city.

He then went back to South Africa, this time leaving his family back in India. Gandhi set up an office in Johannesburg.

He worked as an editor for the weekly newspaper, "Indian Opinion". Around this time Gandhi was strongly influenced by a book he read called "Unto This Last" by John Ruskin.

Gandhi took three main principles from the book's teaching:

1. The good of the individual is contained in the good of all.

2. A lawyer's work has the same value as a barber's, in so much as they all have the same right of earning their livelihood from their work.

3. A life of labor, i.e. manual labor, is a life worth living. Gandhi changed his life according to these points and created the Phoenix Settlement, a farm where he would live with others and publish the Indian Opinion newspaper.

Everyone working there would receive the same salary regardless of race, nationality or job type. Gandhi tried to persuade his European friends at the settlement to get married and also invited Indian friends to bring their families over from home.

It wasn't long until the settlement had developed into a small village. In Phoenix, simplicity was introduced where possible and personal physical labor was preferred.

For example, instead of buying bread from the bakers, they began to make their own. Gandhi brought his family over again and the children were happy to help out with the work.

Then in 1906, the British government declared war against the Zulus in Natal. Gandhi created the Indian ambulance corps again, working on the front line, this time helping carry and nurse innocent, wounded Zulus that had been shot by mistake by the British soldiers.

After the so-called "rebellion" was coming to an end, Gandhi went to Johannesburg. At this time Gandhi began further experimenting with his diet. He practiced fasting and later a pure fruit diet, his ambition is to live the life of the poorest people.

At other times he gave up salt and milk, thinking they were not necessary. His belief in fasting was that it was very helpful when working towards self-restraint. At the outbreak of the First World War, Gandhi was arriving in England on a boat. He planned to participate in an ambulance corps once again but fell ill.

The doctors suggested a temperate climate might aid his recovery, so he returned to India in 1915. Previously while he was in South Africa, Gandhi's thoughts had led to him developing what was to be called "satyagraha".

It translates roughly as "insistence to the truth" and refers to non-violent protest and resistance. In India, Gandhi joined the National Congress. He was now a strong public speaker and negotiator after years of practice.

He was asked by Indian laborers in Champaran to help them as they were being suppressed, taxed and forced to grow crops for their mainly British landlords. Gandhi visited them and proposed satyagraha, i.e. non-violent mass civil disobedience.

He was arrested for creating unrest and was ordered to leave but he refused. Hundreds of thousands of people protested and he was released. Gandhi led the protests against the landlords who eventually signed an agreement offering more compensation to the tenants.

After consulting with friends, Gandhi decided to open primary schools in six villages. All the villagers had to agree to, was to provide board and lodging for the teachers. Gandhi then successfully appealed publically for voluntary teachers.

His next step was to improve the sanitary conditions of the villages. For this, he borrowed doctors from other roles for periods of six months or so. In 1918, Gandhi led another campaign of satyagraha in Kheda, which had been hit by floods. Many peasants there were facing famine and wanted relief from tax payments until the famine was over. In the end, after several months, the government agreed to the delayed payment of the taxes.

During the First World War, Gandhi agreed to actively recruit fellow Indians to help the war effort, despite not willing to injure or kill anybody himself. He believed that the willing of Indians to help the British Empire in its hour of need would quicken and increase the chances of racial distinctions being eradicated within the Empire against Indians.

Around this time, Gandhi also tried to appeal to Indian Muslims and supported them in many of their causes. As a result, Gandhi became popular in both the Hindu and Muslim communities and was able to promote and instigate his form of peaceful resistance across India against the British rule.

Many peaceful civilians were killed by British troops with the intention to prevent a violent uprising, but it only made Gandhi more popular and the movement stronger. He led the Congress to reorganize itself with a new constitution which would work towards complete independence.

Gandhi thought the removal of poverty would help establish independence. One way to achieve this would be to advocate the wearing of homespun cloth instead of British-made clothing materials.

He tried to get as many Indians as possible to make the garments, male or female, rich or poor. Gandhi finishes his autobiography by stating that his latest principal experiments, all made through the Congress, have left history still in the making and his conclusions on the experiments are not yet decisive.

History now proves that his movement for Indian independence was not only ultimately successful, but he has influenced and inspired freedom and civil rights movements throughout the world.

Mahatma Gandhi Universities in India

Mahatma Gandhi himself earned a degree in law from the University College London, in 1891. There is probably not a single town or city in India that does not have a place, road or monument named after the father of the nation.

What is surprising however is that many Universities in India are named after him and hence share a common name! Following are the main universities with the same/similar title.

(1) Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam, Kerala, India:-

This public university was established on 2nd October 1983. Its motto, in English, is Knowledge makes one immortal. It has been graded a not so high (B+) by the National Assessment and Accreditation Council, India. As of 2012, the University has over 200 affiliated colleges spread over five districts in central Kerala.

The University has made significant presence outside its territorial jurisdiction also – most within Kerala, and few outside Kerala including global locations like Ghana, Dubai (UAE), etc.

The University enrolls 1,50,000 students on an average every year to 210 courses in graduate, postgraduate and M. Phil./Ph.D. programs through various departments and colleges.

The University offers various academic programmes in the fields of Gandhian Thought, International Relations and Politics, Technology, Physics, Nano Science, Disability Studies and Rehabilitation Sciences, Special Education and Rehabilitation Sciences, Rehabilitation Psychology, Behavioural Medicine and Rehabilitation, Rehabilitation Nursing, Journalism, Chemical Sciences including Polymer Chemistry, Nursing, Hospital Administration, Environmental Sciences and Disaster Management among others.

Reference: <http://mgu.ac.in/>

(2) Mahatma Gandhi University, Andhra Pradesh, India:-

It was established in the year 2007. The University motto is Academic Excellence. It offers Bachelor and P.G. courses in various fields of education. It is located in the Nalgonda town near Hyderabad.

Reference: <http://mguniversity.ac.in/>

(3) Mahatma Gandhi University, Meghalaya, India:-

It was established in the year 2011. Its motto is Education for All. The mission & vision of the University has centered around “making a difference” in the field of education.

The university offers degree programs in many fields and also offers a distance education program in certain fields.

Reference: <http://www.mgu.edu.in/>

(4) Mahatma Gandhi Kashi Vidyapith, Varanasi, India:-

Kashi Vidyapith having present nomenclature since 1995 as Mahatma Gandhi Kashi Vidyapith was inaugurated by Mahatma Gandhi during the Non-Cooperation movement of the freedom struggle, on the auspicious occasion of Basant Panchami on February 10, 1921.

Its objectives are to strive to enhance and propagate: The development of Indian civilization and culture based on spiritualism.

The homogeneous intermingling of all the sections of Indian society.

Coordination among different thoughts and cultures.

The notion of independence and patriotism along with the feeling of brotherhood and the urge to serve mankind.

The ancient and modern development in the fields of various disciplines of learning, sculpture, science, technology, etc.

Reference: <http://www.mgkvp.ac.in/>

Mahatma Gandhi Movies



There are various movies on the life of Mahatma Gandhi; perhaps the most famous among them is the movie 'Gandhi' made in 1982.

The movie, starring Ben Kingsley and directed by Sir Richard Attenborough, won 8 academy awards, including Academy...

Mahatma Gandhi Quotes

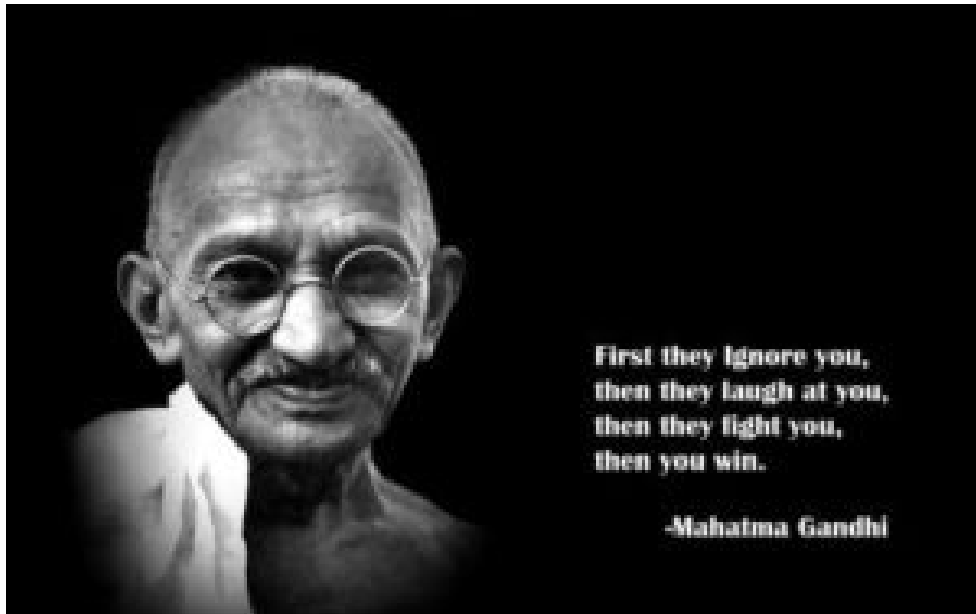
Mahatma Gandhi Quotes on Animals

The greatness of a nation and its moral progress can be judged by the way its animals are treated.

To my mind, the life of a lamb is no less precious than that of a human being. I should be unwilling to take the life of a lamb for the sake of the human body. I hold that the more helpless a creature, the more entitled it is to protection...

I feel that spiritual progress does demand at some stage that we should cease to kill our fellow creatures for the satisfaction of our bodily wants.

Vivisection is the blackest of all the black crimes that a man is at present committing against God and his fair creation. It ill becomes us to invoke in our daily prayers the blessings of God, the Compassionate, if we, in turn, will not practice elementary compassion towards our fellow creatures.



Mahatma Gandhi Quotes on LOVE

I offer you peace. I offer you love. I offer you friendship. I see your beauty. I hear your need. I feel your feelings. My wisdom flows from the Highest Source. I salute that Source in you. Let us work together for unity and love.

Where there is love there is life.

In doing something, do it with love or never do it at all

Is it not enough to know the evil to shun it? If not, we should be sincere enough to admit that we love evil too well to give it up.

Hate the sin and love the sinner.

Mahatma Gandhi Quotes on Life

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| Live as if you were to die tomorrow. Learn as if you were to live forever.

| Truth never damages a cause that is just.

| Where there is love there is life.

| There is more to Life than Increasing its Speed.

Mahatma Gandhi quotes on Peace

| I regard myself as a soldier, though a soldier of peace.

| The sacrifice which causes sorrow to the doer of the sacrifice is no sacrifice. Real sacrifice lightens the mind of the doer and gives him a sense of peace and joy. The Buddha gave up the pleasures of life because they had become painful to him.

| The cry for peace will be a cry in the wilderness, so long as the spirit of nonviolence does not dominate millions of men and women.

| If we are to teach real peace in this world, and if we are to carry on a real war against war, we shall have to begin with the children.

| I offer you peace. I offer you love. I offer you friendship. I see your beauty. I hear your need. I feel your feelings. My wisdom flows from the Highest Source. I salute that Source in you. Let us work together for unity and love.

Mahatma Gandhi Quotes on Freedom

| Freedom is not worth having if it does not connote freedom to err. It passes my comprehension how human beings, be they ever so experienced and able, can delight in depriving other human beings of that precious right.

| I'm a lover of my own liberty, and so I would do nothing to restrict yours.

| If India adopted the doctrine of love as an active part of her religion and introduced it in her politics, Swaraj (Independence) would descend upon India from heaven. But I am painfully aware that that event is far off as yet.

| I want freedom for the full expression on my personality.

| Freedom is not worth having if it does not include the freedom to make mistakes.



Mahatma Gandhi on Thoughts

| Always aim at complete harmony of thought and word and deed. Always aim at purifying your thoughts and everything will be well.

| Happiness is when what you think, what you say, and what you do are in harmony.

Mahatma Gandhi on Violence

| Nonviolence is the first article of my faith. It is also the last article of my creed.

| The ideally non-violent state will be an ordered anarchy. That State is the best governed which is governed the least.

| I object to violence because when it appears to do good, the good is only temporary the evil it does is permanent.

I first learned the concepts of nonviolence in my marriage.

If one has no affection for a person or a system, one should feel free to give the fullest expression to his disaffection so long as he does not contemplate, promote, or incite violence.

Nonviolence is the first article of my faith. It is also the last article of my creed.

It is better to be violent, if there is violence in our hearts, than to put on the cloak of nonviolence to cover impotence.

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